

GREGG WILLIAMS

Williams Bookends Disaster With Brilliance

A quadruple bogey at the first and another at the last couldn't stop Gregg Williams running away with the best round of the day on Estoril's TEG debut.

Gregg Williams began his Estoril Golf Club career with a quadruple bogey 8 at the 1st. It is one of the hardest holes on the course, which is the kindest thing available to say about it. He responded with admirable calm. A bogey at the 2nd, then a birdie at the 3rd, and the bleeding stopped.

What followed was the best golf anyone produced all day. Back-to-back birdies at the 3rd and 4th carried him to the outright lead in the TEG 15 Trophy. By the 11th he held the

outright lead in the TEG 15 Green Jacket as well. He then kept house with real discipline: par and par at the 8th and 9th, par and par again at the 13th and 14th. A man in complete command of his own affairs.

Then came the 18th. Another quadruple bogey 8. The day ended precisely as it had started, as though the round had been written with symmetry in mind and nobody had consulted Williams about it.

AT A GLANCE

ROUND OF THE DAY
Gregg WILLIAMS (39 pts)

TROPHY LEAD
Gregg WILLIAMS, 5 ahead

GREEN JACKET LEAD
Gregg WILLIAMS, 8 ahead

ROUND STABLEFORD
GW 39 | JP 34 | JB 31 | SN 31 | AB 30 | DM 30
ROUND GROSS
GW +17 | DM +25 | JB +27 | JP +27 | AB +30 | SN +37

AFTER R1 • TROPHY
GW 39 | JP 34 | JB 31 | SN 31 | AB 30 | DM 30
AFTER R1 • GREEN JACKET
GW +17 | DM +25 | JB +27 | JP +27 | AB +30 | SN +37

WOODEN SPOON

David Mullin And Alex Baker Share Cellar

Stuart Neumann's sextuple bogey at the 15th threatened to join them, but a late rally left David Mullin and Alex Baker alone at the foot of the TEG 15 Wooden Spoon table after round one.

Round 1 at Estoril saw David Mullin and Stuart Neumann take turns at the bottom of TEG 15's Wooden Spoon race. Neumann moved first. A quintuple bogey 9 at the 3rd deposited him in last place, and the 15th brought a sextuple bogey 10, his heaviest blow against par of the whole trip. To his credit, he then finished like a man with

something to prove, gathering 9 points over the closing three holes from a bogey and two pars.

Mullin's turn arrived later and was no less thorough. A quadruple bogey 8 at the 12th, one of Estoril's harder holes, was followed by a triple bogey at the 17th, which is the easiest hole on the

course and thus offered no excuses at all. That was sufficient to relieve Neumann of the Spoon cellar. Both men were seeing Estoril for the first time. Both had occupied last place in the Wooden Spoon standings before the tournament reached its second round. Not every debut needs to be this comprehensive.

JON BAKER

Two Quintuple Bogeys Sink Jon Baker

Level for the outright TEG 15 Trophy lead through ten holes, Jon Baker's card capsized with matching nines at the 11th and 12th.

Jon Baker assembled his position patiently across the front nine at Estoril. Pars at the 8th, 9th and 10th brought him nine points over that stretch. After ten holes he was level at the top of the 2022 TEG Trophy. His front nine of 31 points was a serious piece of work, and stood well clear of what came next.

The turn dismantled it. The 11th, one of the hardest holes on the course, produced a quintuple bogey and ended the run of pars. The 12th produced another quintuple bogey, as if to confirm the first had not been a clerical error. Ten holes of construction, demolished in two. A quadruple bogey at the 17th, the easiest hole on

the course, added a further layer of insult. Baker's 96 was still his best gross of the TEG so far, which tells you something about the TEG so far. The card reads as two rounds by two different men. Only one of them was ever near the lead.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 15, Round 1

RARE FEATS

— Stuart Neumann runs up a 10 (+6) at the 15th — his career-worst on a par-4